EL AL ISRAEL AIRLINES

Conversational AI Check-in Agent

Outbound Voice AI Agent · Hebrew

Ofir Menda · Jeen.ai AI Voice Agent Home Assignment

Two Voice AI Use Cases

Improving the EL AL customer experience across the passenger journey

INBOUND

AI Flight Assistant

Passengers call before their flight and get personalized answers based on their booking - baggage allowance, terminal, check-in status, flight timing, or add-ons.

The agent reads the reservation directly, so there's no menu to navigate and no wait for a human rep.

OUTBOUND

★ SELECTED

Conversational AI Check-in Agent

When online check-in opens, the agent proactively calls the passenger and completes check-in through a short, natural Hebrew conversation.

Using booking context, it asks contextual questions and offers relevant services - checked baggage, priority boarding, lounge, meals, upgrades - sometimes at a voice-channel discount.

Selected Use Case - Business Value

Outbound Conversational AI Check-in Agent

Customer Experience Value

- A short call replaces multiple screens - passengers ask questions naturally and get instant clarification.
- Context (destination, date, ticket type, baggage) personalizes the conversation, surfacing missing services early.

Financial Value

- Context-based ancillary offers (baggage, boarding, lounge, upgrades) at the right moment lift conversion.
- Automating routine check-in reduces simple requests to human agents - operational cost savings.

Why Voice AI fits this use case

Natural language

Passengers just say what they need - "add a bag only for the return" - no screens to search.

Conversational selling

Uses booking context to ask follow-ups and suggest relevant services, like assistance, not an ad.

Personal & warm

Adapts tone and destination context, turning a transactional task into a service conversation.

Model Comparison

Compared within equivalent categories, on the 3 parameters that matter most for this agent

STT

Speech-to-Text

✔ Deepgram Nova-3

	Real-time latency	Accuracy (WER)	Real-time agent fit
Deepgram Nova-3 ✔	330 ms	2.7% WER	Mature real-time infra
Scribe v2 RT	570 ms	~10-20% WER	Agent-native design

LLM

Language Model

✔ GPT-5.6 Terra

	Controllability	Tool / function calling	Cost
GPT-5.6 Terra ✔	Controlled tool calls	Strong agent ecosystem	Higher
Gemini 3.6 Flash	Validated call modes	Supported, needs testing	Lower / efficient

TTS

Text-to-Speech

✔ Vapi Voice

	Voice naturalness ★	Pronunciation	Accent
Vapi Voice ✔	Most human, lifelike	Correct Hebrew reading	Slight speaker accent
Azure Neural	Natural but less human	Incorrect pronunciation	Neutral

★ *Voice naturalness was decisive: Vapi sounded the most human. Its one trade-off was a slight speaker accent, while Azure had incorrect Hebrew pronunciation.*

Why We Choose Each Model

The reasoning behind each selected component, for this use case

STT

Deepgram Nova-3

- Lowest latency (330 ms) for fast, responsive turns
- Very low error rate (2.7% WER)
- Mature, production-grade real-time STT infrastructure

Best latency and accuracy for a live check-in call.

LLM

GPT-5.6 Terra

- Drives the critical decisions: intent, action, when to clarify, tool calls
- High controllability + dependable function calling
- Chosen over cheaper models: reliability beats cost here

Reliability and tool use outweigh model cost.

TTS

Vapi Voice

- Most human, lifelike voice - passengers stay engaged
- Correct Hebrew reading (Azure mispronounced words)
- Accepted trade-off: a slight speaker accent

A natural, human voice is central to the experience.

Selected Models & Agent Architecture

STT
Deepgram Nova-3

LLM
GPT-5.6 Terra

TTS
Vapi Hebrew Voice

Outbound Call Flow

1. Check-in opens (trigger)
2. Agent calls passenger
3. STT → LLM: intent + context
4. Contextual ancillary offers
5. Confirm & complete check-in
6. Summary written back to Sheet

Dynamic Variables (pulled per call)

- Passenger name
- Destination
- Ticket type
- Baggage allowance

Data Source
Google Sheets

Variables read before the call · conversation summary written back to the same sheet after the call.

Expected Business Value & ROI

Monthly model - based on public EL AL figures and industry benchmarks (assumptions, to be validated on real data)

EXPECTED ROI

≈ 403%

For every $1 invested,
≈ $4.03 in net additional
revenue - plus the $1 back.

105,400

AI conversations / month

527K passengers × 20% engagement

+$244K

Ancillary revenue uplift

10% uplift on context-based offers

$48.5K

Monthly Voice AI cost

105.4K calls × 4 min × $0.115

$195,622

Net monthly benefit

Uplift - cost (savings excluded)

Turns a mandatory check-in task into a personalized service experience and an ancillary-revenue opportunity - with operational savings on top.